

Loveliest of trees

Text: A. E. Housman, 1896

Music: Pierre de Corbeil, harmonized Richard Redhead, 1853

ORIENTIS PARTIBUS 77.77

The musical score is written for a three-part setting in D major, 3/4 time. It consists of four systems of music, each with a treble and bass staff. The lyrics are arranged in three stanzas. The first system covers the first line of the first stanza. The second system covers the second and third lines of the first stanza. The third system covers the fourth and fifth lines of the first stanza. The fourth system covers the sixth and seventh lines of the first stanza. The score includes various musical notations such as chords, single notes, and rests. The lyrics are printed below the notes, with hyphens indicating syllables that span across notes or measures.

1 Love - liest of trees, the cher - ry now,
2 Now of my three - score years and ten,
3 And since to look at things in bloom

hung with bloom a - long the bough,
tween - ty will not come a - gain.
fif - ty springs are lit - tle room,

it stands a - bout the wood - land ride
And take from sev'n - ty springs a score,
a - bout the wood - lands I will go,

wear - ing white for Eas - ter - tide.
leav - ing me just fif - ty more.
see the cher - ry hung with snow.